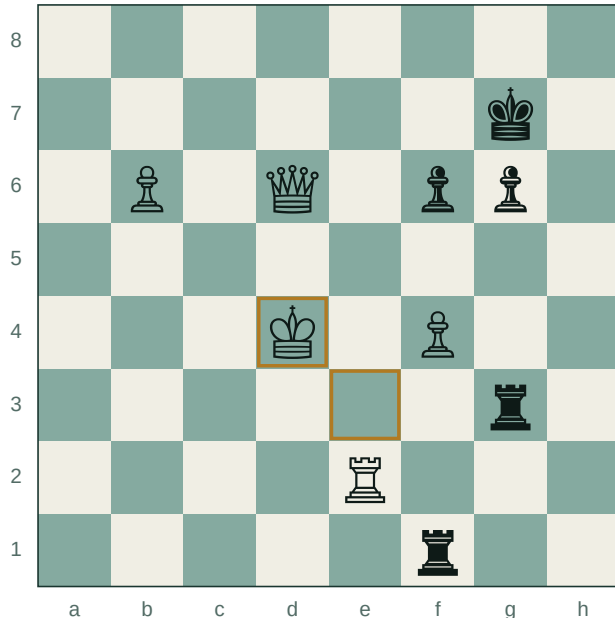


Queen-and-rook endings: Black, move 63

Queen-and-rook endings

Black to move



Previous move: 63.Kd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

63...Rd1+ 64. Kc5 Rc3+ 65. Kb4 Rxd6 66. Kxc3 Rxb6

63...Rd1+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **64.Kc5**.

64...Rc3+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **65.Kb4**.

65...Rxd6 The rook captures the queen on d6. Recorded reply: **66.Kxc3**.

66...Rxb6 The rook captures the pawn on b6.

At the end, nominal material is White 6 / Black 7 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -4 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on d4. Geometrically undefended: queen on d6 and rook on e2. Check for tactical protection.